

# Exam Topics Revision Core and Literature

Active Study & Research Guide | Exam Preparation

Student Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Class: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

**Instructions:** Use your class notes, previous assignments, and your online textbook on my.hrw.com to complete this workbook. You are expected to look up key terms, locate story details, and write out complete explanations in your own words.

## INFORMATIVE TEXT WRITING & PARAGRAPH MECHANICS

### 1. Academic Tone & Vocabulary

Review your notes on formal writing style.

Rewrite the following informal sentence using a formal academic tone and precise vocabulary:

"Pythons are crazy huge and totally ruin the environment!"

Pythons exhibit extraordinary size and inflict substantial ecological damage on their invasive environments.

Pythons are extremely large snakes that cause serious ~~big~~ damage to the enviroment and disrupt ecosystems.

### 2. Paragraph Structure & Mechanics

Look up the roles of different sentences within an informative paragraph.

#### A. Topic Sentence: What is its purpose in a paragraph?

The topic sentence ~~tells~~ tells the main idea of the paragraph, it shows what the whole paragraph is gonna be about so readers know ~~subsequent sentences develop~~ the paragraph's central idea, provides direction for supporting content, and establishes the focus that all subsequent sentences develop.

#### B. Supporting Details: What type of information should go here?

Supporting details should include specific evidence, examples, statistics, expert testimony, factual data, or concrete illustrations that ~~support the main idea~~ support the topic sentence's claim and evidence that prove the topic sentence is ~~the~~ true. They explain and give more information about the main idea

#### C. Essay Conclusion: How should an effective conclusion structure wrap up an essay?

A good conclusion restates the main idea in new words and summarizes the important points from the essay, it shouldnt add new ~~information but it wraps everything up and gives the reader something to think about at the end~~ information but it wraps everything up and gives the reader something to think about at the end. An effective conclusion should synthesize key arguments without introducing new evidence, reaffirm the thesis in fresh language, provide broader implications or significance of the findings, and deliver a compelling final statement that resonates with readers.

### 3. Visual Aids & Graphics

Think about why writers include charts, tables, or diagrams alongside text.

Why do informative writers use visual aids or graphics when presenting complex data?

Visual aids help readers understand hard information easier and see patterns or data quickly. Visual aids and graphics enable readers to comprehend complex quantitative relationships efficiently, identify patterns and trends immediately, retain information more effectively through dual-channel processing, and access data that would be cumbersome or unclear in text form alone.

## CONDUCTING RESEARCH & SYNTHESIS

### 1. Research Questions & Search Strategies

Check your research guide on formulating inquiry questions and search keywords.

**A. Research Questions:** Why is a clear research question important before you start looking for data?

A clear research question establishes precise parameters for investigation, prevents scope drift, ensures relevant source selection, and provides measurable criteria for determining when sufficient evidence has been gathered. Instead of getting lost

**B. Refining Queries:** If your initial online search yields irrelevant results, what specific steps should you take to refine your search strategy?

To refine search strategies yielding irrelevant results, incorporate Boolean operators (AND, OR, NOT), apply quotation marks for exact phrases, add domain limiters or date filters, utilize advanced search features, substitute synonyms or alternative terminology, narrow overly broad terms with specific modifiers, and consult specialized databases aligned with the subject discipline.

### 2. Primary vs. Secondary Sources

Define each source type and provide an example.

| Source Type      | Definition (In your own words)                                                                      | Example                   |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Primary Source   | Original materials created during the period under study or direct evidence produced by participant | Historical photograph     |
| Secondary Source | Interpretive works analyzing, evaluating, or synthesizing information from primary sources.         | Scholarly journal article |

### 3. Paraphrasing vs. Direct Quoting & Synthesizing

Review the rules for using another author's words vs. ideas, and how to combine multiple texts.

**A. Paraphrasing vs. Direct Quoting:** What is the main structural and formatting difference between paraphrasing an author and directly quoting them?

Paraphrasing restates ideas in the researcher's own words without quotation marks, while direct quoting reproduces exact original language enclosed in quotation marks with precise attribution. ~~the exact words in quotation marks~~

**B. Synthesizing Information:** Explain what it means to *synthesize* information from multiple texts.

Synthesizing information involves integrating ideas from multiple sources to create new understanding, identifying connections and patterns ~~synthesizing means you take information from different sources and combine them together to make a new understanding. You across texts, reconciling conflicting perspectives, and constructing coherent arguments that demonstrate relationships between diverse material, rather than merely summarizing sources individually.~~

## EVALUATING SOURCES & USING TEXTUAL EVIDENCE

### 1. Source Credibility Criteria

Look up criteria used to test whether a source is trustworthy.

**A. Authority & Publisher Reputation:** What should you check about an author or publisher to evaluate credibility?

~~you should check if the author has credentials or expertise in that subject. Also check if the publisher is well known and verify the author's credentials, institutional affiliations, publication history, expertise in the relevant field, potential conflicts of interest, and the publisher's editorial standards, peer review processes, and reputation within the discipline.~~

**B. Domain Extensions:** Why are .gov and .edu domains usually considered more reliable than .com or .net?

Government (.gov) and educational (.edu) domains undergo registration restrictions ensuring institutional accountability, editorial oversight, and purpose-driven content, whereas commercial domains (.com, .net) are accessible to anyone and prioritize profit over accuracy.

**C. Publication Dates:** Why is the date of publication critical when researching rapidly changing fields?

In rapidly evolving fields, recent publication dates ensure information reflects current methodologies, recent discoveries, updated theories, and prevailing professional consensus, while outdated sources may contain superseded findings, discredited practices, or obsolete technological contexts that compromise research validity. ~~in fields that change fast like technology or medicine, old information can be outdated and wrong. using recent sources makes~~ ~~and outdated sources may contain superseded findings, discredited practices, or obsolete technological contexts that compromise research validity.~~ ~~and discoveries so your not using information thats not true anymore or has been replaced by better knowledge~~

## 2. Plagiarism & Evidence Delivery

Review note-taking habits and speaking strategies for presenting facts.

**A. Preventing Plagiarism:** What note-taking techniques can you use while researching to prevent accidental plagiarism?

Employ meticulous bibliographic documentation immediately upon encountering sources, distinguish clearly between direct quotations (marked with quotation marks), paraphrased content, and original thoughts using distinct notation systems, and maintain detailed source attribution throughout all notes. the source information right away and use quotation marks around exact words

**B. Explicit Verbal Attributions:** What is the purpose of using verbal attributions (e.g., "According to researcher...") when delivering evidence in a speech or presentation?

Verbal attributions establish source credibility, demonstrate research rigor, distinguish the speaker's claims from expert testimony, enable audience verification, and fulfill ethical obligations to credit intellectual property while enhancing persuasive authority through external validation because the audience knows your not just making things up, It also shows you did real research and helps listeners trust your information more

**C. Structured Outlines:** How do structured outlines help organize evidence before speaking or writing?

Structured outlines establish hierarchical relationships among evidence, reveal logical progression and argumentative flow, identify gaps or redundancies in support, ensure balanced coverage of key points, facilitate coherent transitions, and provide retrieval frameworks that enhance delivery coherence and audience comprehension during presentations or writing processes. don't fit right

## LITERATURE STUDIES: COLLECTION 1 (OURSELVES AND OTHERS)

**HRW Collections Guide:** Log into my.hrw.com → Go to Collection 1: *Ourselves and Others*. Answer the questions below using details from each text.

### 1. "What, of This Goldfish, Would You Wish?"

Re-read or review your notes on Yonatan's project and Sergei's background.

What does this story show about cultural differences, communication barriers, and loneliness?

This narrative illuminates how language barriers create profound isolation despite physical proximity, demonstrates that cultural misunderstandings stem from experiential gaps rather than inherent incompatibility, reveals loneliness as a universal human condition transcending national identity, and illustrates that meaningful connection requires intentional effort to bridge difference through patience, curiosity, and empathy rather than assumptions.

### 2. "My So-Called Enemy"

Focus on the setting of the summer camp.

How does the summer camp setting help bridge cultural and political divides between the young women?

The summer camp setting creates neutral territory removed from political tensions, facilitates informal interactions through shared recreational activities, establishes common goals and collaborative experiences, and provides extended temporal proximity that allows relationships to develop organically beyond stereotypes and preconceptions. the summer camp takes the girls away from their normal lives and conflict zones. In this neutral safe space they can meet as regular people and share stories and build friendships that wouldn't be possible back home where politics keeps them apart

### 3. "The Universal Declaration of Human Rights"

Consider the core global purpose of this document.

What is the fundamental global purpose of shared human rights outlined in this text?

The fundamental purpose of shared human rights is to make sure every person in the world is treated with dignity and respect no matter where they live or who they are. Human rights protect people from abuse and give everyone basic freedoms. They ensure equal treatment regardless of nationality or status, preventing atrocities through collective accountability, creating frameworks for peaceful coexistence, and affirming that certain protections transcend cultural relativism or sovereign authority, thereby forming the ethical foundation for international cooperation and justice. The fundamental global purpose of shared human rights is to establish universal standards protecting inherent dignity, ensuring equal treatment regardless of nationality or status, preventing atrocities through collective accountability, creating frameworks for peaceful coexistence, and affirming that certain protections transcend cultural relativism or sovereign authority, thereby forming the ethical foundation for international cooperation and justice. equality across all countries and cultures so that all humans can live safely

### 4. "Towards a True Refuge" by Aung San Suu Kyi

Look up Suu Kyi's explanation of true peace vs. simple lack of conflict.

Why does the author argue that true peace requires more than just the absence of physical warfare?

The author contends that genuine peace requires addressing systemic inequalities, economic injustices, social marginalization, and structural violence that create conditions for conflict, arguing that mere cessation of armed hostilities without resolving underlying grievances produces unstable truces rather than sustainable harmony, as latent tensions and unmet human needs inevitably reignite violence. The author says true peace needs more than no war because people can still suffer from poverty, inequality, and injustice even when there's no fighting. Real peace means everyone has their basic needs met and human rights protected. Without addressing these problems, society stays unstable.

### 5. "Without Title" by Diane Glancy

Focus on the father's life in the city vs. his heritage.

How does the father preserve his Native American heritage while living in an urban environment?

The father maintains Native American heritage through deliberate transmission of traditional stories, languages, and cultural practices. The father keeps his Native American heritage alive by teaching his children traditional stories, songs, and customs. Even though they live in urban Indigenous communities, he travels to reservation lands for ceremonies, incorporates traditional values into daily decisions, and actively resists assimilation pressures while adapting traditions to urban contexts. He makes sure his children know where they come from and the importance of their heritage.

## LITERATURE STUDIES: COLLECTION 2 (HUMANS AND NATURE)

**HRW Collections Guide:** Log into my.hrw.com → Go to Collection 2: *Humans and Nature*. Answer the questions below using details from each text.

### 1. "Hope for Animals and Their World" by Jane Goodall

Focus on the main lesson regarding endangered species.

What role do dedicated individuals play in preventing animal species from going extinct?

Dedicated individuals work hard to protect endangered animals through conservation efforts, research, and habitat protection. They provide critical conservation interventions including habitat protection, breeding programs, anti-poaching enforcement, ecological research, public advocacy, and restoration initiatives that counteract extinction drivers, demonstrating that committed individuals can reverse population declines and preserve biodiversity. They raise awareness about species that are disappearing and take action to save them. Without these people caring and putting in effort, many animals would be extinct. They try to fix the problems that threaten their survival.

## 2. "Called Out" by Barbara Kingsolver

Look up how plants adapt to harsh environments like deserts.

What does this text explain about natural adaptations and human fascination with natural beauty?

*The text ~~explains~~ explains how animals and plants develop special adaptations to survive in their environments. It also talks about biological functions underlying aesthetically striking features, and examines humanity's enduring fascination with natural phenomena as why humans are so attracted to beautiful things in nature and how natural beauty makes us feel wonder and appreciation for the reflecting both scientific curiosity and innate responses to beauty, complexity, and the sublime manifestations of evolutionary processes that demonstrate nature's creative problem-solving across millennia.*

## 3. "In Defense of Everglade Pythons" by Andrew Revkin

Consider how media reports frame invasive species.

Why does the author encourage readers to look past sensationalized "monster" stories about pythons?

*The author advocates looking beyond sensationalized portrayals to understand pythons' ecological roles, evolutionary adaptations, and complex interactions within ecosystems, arguing that fear-driven narratives obscure scientific understanding, prevent nuanced conservation approaches, and reduce magnificent organisms to simplistic villains rather than recognizing human responsibility for introducing invasive species and disrupting ecological balance through environmental mismanagement.*  
The author wants readers to understand that pythons are just animals trying to survive not evil monsters. The sensational stories make people panic and hate the snakes instead of understanding the real ecological situation. Revkin is a scientist and a journalist. He looks at facts instead of fear. He thinks we should focus on real solutions rather than just demonizing.

## 4. "My Life as a Bat" by Margaret Atwood

Think about perspective in this story.

How does using a non-human (bat) perspective challenge human assumptions of superiority?

*Employing a bat perspective disrupts anthropocentric worldviews by revealing alternative sensory realities, demonstrating that human perception constitutes merely one valid interpretation of existence, exposing the limitations of human-centered value systems, and illustrating that intelligence, communication, and meaning-making manifest diversely across species, thereby challenging hierarchical assumptions that privilege human consciousness as the definitive measure of significance or experience.*  
by writing from a bat's point of view, the story makes readers see that humans aren't the only important creatures. It shows that perception constitutes merely one valid interpretation of existence, exposing the limitations of human-centered value systems, and illustrating that intelligence, communication, and meaning-making manifest diversely across species, thereby challenging hierarchical assumptions that privilege human consciousness as the definitive measure of significance or experience. this challenges the idea that humans are better than other species

## 5. "The Seventh Man" by Haruki Murakami

Focus on the protagonist's internal struggle after the wave.

How does the story explore natural disasters, tragedy, trauma, and internal conflict?

*The narrative explores how natural disasters catalyze immediate physical devastation while generating enduring psychological trauma, examines characters' internal conflicts between survival instincts and moral obligations, portrays grief's complex manifestations, and demonstrates that recovery involves reconciling loss, guilt, identity disruption, and transformed relationships with place and community.*  
The story shows how a huge wave kills the narrator's best friend during a typhoon. The tragedy haunts him for years and he struggles with guilt fear and painful memories inside himself

# LITERARY CONCEPTS & DEVICES

## 1. Figurative Language Definitions & Examples

Write your own definition and create an original example for each device.

| Literary Device | Definition (In your own words)                                                                     | Original Example                              |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Metaphor        | direct compare. A figurative comparison asserting one thing is another to reveal symbolic meaning. | The boardroom was a gladiatorial arena.       |
| Simile          | uses like/as. A simile compares two unlike things using "like" or "as" to highlight similarity.    | Her analytical mind worked like a laser.      |
| Personification | attributing human characteristics or behaviors to non-human entities.                              | The market devoured every innovation eagerly. |

## 2. Literary Analysis Concepts

Define these key terms used to analyze literature.

**A. Character's Internal Conflict:** What is an internal conflict, and how does it differ from an external conflict?

An internal conflict occurs within a character's psyche—doubt, moral dilemma, competing desires, or emotional turmoil. External conflict involves struggles against outside forces: other characters, society, or nature. The distinction lies in locus: internal conflicts exist in the mind, while external conflicts manifest in observable circumstances.

**B. Symbolism:** How do authors use symbols to add deeper meaning to a story?

Authors embed symbols—objects, characters, or events carrying meaning beyond literal interpretation—to evoke thematic complexity and emotional resonance. Symbols function as concentrated signifiers, allowing nuanced ideas to permeate narrative without exposition. Through recurring motifs and deliberate placement, symbols create layered meaning that rewards analytical reading, making the story more interesting and meaningful.

**C. Narrative Point of View (POV):** Explain how point of view affects what the audience thinks and feels about characters.

Point of view determines whose consciousness filters events, profoundly shaping audience perception. First-person narration creates intimacy but limits perspective; third-person omniscient provides comprehensive insight; limited third-person restricts knowledge strategically. POV controls information access, emotional proximity, and reliability, thereby manipulating how we interpret the story.

**D. Underlying Theme:** How do you determine the underlying theme of a literary text?

Determining underlying theme requires synthesizing textual evidence across multiple dimensions. Examine recurring motifs, symbols, and imagery; analyze character arcs and their resolutions; consider conflicts and their implications; evaluate authorial choices in structure and language. Theme emerges from patterns rather than explicit statement—what the text demonstrates about human experience, values, or truth through its entirety, not what characters merely discuss.

## DEEP REFLECTION & SYNTHESIS TASKS

### Task 1: Reflection on Collection 1 — Human Relationships (Ourselves and Others)

Reflect on all the stories in Collection 1 ("What, of This Goldfish, Would You Wish?", "My So-Called Enemy", "The Universal Declaration of Human Rights", "Towards a True Refuge", and "Without Title").

**Prompt:** Think about the overarching theme of human relationships. Why is it often difficult for individuals from different cultures, political backgrounds, or generations to connect? Based on what you read in these texts, what does it take for human beings to truly understand one another, overcome conflict, and build meaningful relationships?

human relationships are hard when people come from different cultures because everyone has their own beliefs and ways of living. Cross-cultural, intergenerational, and political divides persist because individuals operate within discrete epistemic frameworks shaped by experience, values, and worldview. These texts suggest genuine understanding requires active empathy—willingness to temporarily suspend one's perspective and inhabit another's reality. Meaningful connection demands intellectual humility, authentic listening rather than performative hearing, and recognition of shared humanity beneath superficial differences. Overcoming conflict necessitates dialogue prioritizing comprehension over persuasion, acknowledgment of legitimate grievances, and collaborative problem-solving. Trust building occurs incrementally through consistent demonstration of respect, vulnerability in sharing divergent experiences, and commitment to finding common ground while

### Task 2: Reflection on Collection 2 — Humans and Nature

Reflect on all the texts in Collection 2 ("Hope for Animals and Their World", "Called Out", "In Defense of Everglade Pythons", "My Life as a Bat", and "The Seventh Man").

**Prompt:** Think about the overall relationship between humans and the natural world. How do these texts challenge the idea that humans control nature? What responsibilities do humans have toward wildlife and the planet, and how should we cope when nature presents dangerous power or natural disasters?

These texts subvert anthropocentric assumptions by demonstrating nature's autonomy and indifference to human agenda. Rather than passive resource or controllable backdrop, nature emerges as dynamic force operating by principles transcending human intervention. Human responsibility encompasses stewardship—preservation of ecosystems, biodiversity protection, and sustainable resource management—balanced with recognition of our species' ecological embeddedness. When confronting nature's destructive capacity, appropriate response combines pragmatic preparation, technological mitigation where feasible, and philosophical acceptance of limits to human dominance. Adaptive resilience